

Win 8 Kinnected

From some of the slides, it seems the next generation motion sensor video technology for the Xbox 360 is likely to be ported to Windows 8



Windows Ate 7, Already?

Last month, loads of confidential slides from deep within the lairs of Microsoft's Windows client development team, found their way onto the internet. They gave us a glimpse of what's to come in Windows 8. Here's our analysis and what we'd like to see in the next version of the world's most widely used operating system

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If we were superstitious geeks we'd say that Windows 8, is most likely going to be a dud. Why? Well right from the time of Windows 3.1, every alternate Windows offering has severely bombed. So while XP sorta rocked with the infusion of numerous service packs, nothing could save the sinking ship that was Vista. Windows 7 on the other hand was unanimously heralded as Microsoft's big comeback.

But why are we talking about Windows 8 already? Wasn't 7 just recently launched? In fact some of you might've not even switched to the new OS yet. There's an emphatic 'yes' on all counts. And yet Microsoft has been furiously working on its successor already. If the confidential slides that leaked on to an Italian site (windowsette.com) are to be believed, developmental work has hit major milestones. One of the reasons why the authenticity of these slides is suspect is because the exact source cannot be pinpointed. Some bloggers have traced the earliest appearance to win7vista.com who were supposedly responsible for the painstaking removal of watermarks identifying the OEM to whom the slides were allegedly released under NDA.

Rumour has it that the Windows 8 beta might ship as early as July 2011. The slides only mention that it will be available "for the holiday" so it's anyone's guess as to which holiday that might be. Apparently, this data was released released to OEMs,

such as HP or Dell, as part of Microsoft's PC partners programme. On further inspection of these mystery slides, we realised they're much more than just plans for PC partners. They're internal thought notes covering a whole range of things, right from market segmentation, developer ecosystems to concept PCs. So without any more suspense lets find what some of the more shocking revelations from the slides were.

Apple adoration

Perhaps the most telltale sign that Windows pays attention to the Mac world is a slide titled 'How Apple does it a virtuous cycle'. Funnily enough, it describes how Apple creates value for its customers and why people are willing to pay for their products (as opposed to Windows?). Another truism mentioned is that Apple products 'just work'. Now again comes the issue of the authenticity of these slides. Could this be an elaborate Apple campaign? In fact the next two examples we have for you, have a little of Apple written all over them.

Prototype

A rather strange looking prototype which some in the Digit Team described as an iMac experiment gone bad, was found in one of the slides. Yet there is still divided opinion about whether to love or hate it. Some actually liked this render of the prototype machine. Another important

angle that comes out of this revelation is that Microsoft is most likely going to dictate strict terms to OEMs in terms of specifications and form.



Windows 8 machine specifications

Windows Store

Microsoft has already tried to mimic Apple's App store in the form of Windows Marketplace for Windows Phone devices, without phenomenal results. But would an app store for a full fledged operating system be useful? Isn't the vast wilderness of the internet anyway a free-for-all app store for Windows? That being said a repository or linux style package manager may not be such a bad idea. This also ties in well with one of the points we've mentioned in Digit's Top 8 for Windows 8. If a touch shell is actually executed for tablets or even for converting a netbook into a tablet, an app store will come in handy. App store results are slated to appear in Bing and there's also a Wakapoo (<http://wakoopa.com/wakapoo>) style social app discovery mechanism in store (forgive the pun). An interesting point on one of slides states the store as "Revenue Neutral". Wow, no \$\$ for Ms?